The World's Greatest Toe Show (10 MIN HI CUT)
By Nancy Lamb and Muff Singer
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(There is room for a narrator character. It could be sprinkled more throughout. They could also be manipulated to just be Emily. Some of the characters could also be combined if they appear too similar in performance.)

The Canal Street Club wouldn't have caused so much trouble if Emily Anderson Hadn't saved her Father's toe. Or if Franke Stevens hadn't wanted to be a famous movie extra. Or if Bunny Bigalow and Violetta Epstien hadn't been so obnoxious.

After Mr. Bottoms, the principal of Washington Elementary, announced the plan for the school's Spring Fair, Frankie Stevens called an emergency meeting with the Canal Street Club. All the club members were in fifth grade, except for Frankie's little sister, Tulu, who was only in first grade.

Frankie: If we win the Grand Prize, It's our big chance to be rich and famous. Just think of it. If we put together the booth that makes the most money, we can win and be extras in a real Hollywood movie."

Tulu: YES . . . What's an extra?

Frankie: In movies, they hang out in the back. Like the kids on bicycles in E.T.

Tulu: Extras aren't allowed to talk?

Frankie: A career has to start somewhere.

Spike: What kind of booth should we have? My grandmother reads palms.

Spike Piranna lived with his grandparents. Spike's grandmother read palms and horoscopes and tea leaves. She could have told the club that there was trouble ahead at the Spring Fair. But nobody asked her.

Frankie: Noah Benchley has signed up for a fortune-telling booth with Ouija board and Eight-ball,

Tulu: I could make cupcakes with sprinkles.

Frankie: Bunny Bigalow is planning a bake sale booth.

Spike: Yuck! Have you ever tasted Mrs. Epstien's brownies? They taste like chocolate dog food.

Fankie: Wouldn't you bake gross food if you had Violetta for a daughter.

Tulu: I'd bake Violetta if I had her for a daughter.

Fankie: She and Bunny Bigalow are the most stuck up girls in Fifth grade. There's nothing they'd like better than beating us out for the Grand Prize. The thought of those two being in the movie instead of us makes me sick.

Tulu: Everybody likes bake sales. We'll never beat them.

Emily: I have an Idea. I never told anybody about this - not even my parents.

Frankie: Tell us!

Emily: What about a toe show?

Frankie: Huh?

Emily: A toe show.

Spike: . . .

Tulu: Like dancing?

Emily: No. This has nothing to do with dancing.

INTRO

Spike: Cool.

Frankie: Nasty. With your bare hands?

Emily: Of course.

Frankie: What did you do?

Emily: I saved it. In a matchbox.

Spike: Where?

Emily: Under the bed.

Frankie: You sleep with a toe?!

Emily: What was I supposed to do? I couldn't throw it in the trash.

Frankie: Creepy.

Spike: Gross.

Emily: My father caught his bare foot in the wheel of his bike and cut off his toe. I couldn't just leave it there. HERE IT IS!

Spike: Nasty!

Frankie: Looks like a yellow prune with a grey tonail.

Tulu: It's wierd.

Frankie: It's different. Everyone in the school will want to see your father's toe. We'll make more money than Bunny Bigalow and Viloletta Epsteien. We'll make more money than anybody in the history of Spring Fairs.

Spike: What should be charge for admission?

Emily: Fifty cents a peek. Seventy-five cents a touch.

Spike: What should we call our booth?

Frankie: "Come and see it, ladies and gentlemen! Come and touch it, folks! This is a once-in-a-lifetime opportunity. For a limited time only, see The World's Greatest Toe Show!"

MAYBE INTRO HERE

Violetta Epstien: What's a toe show?

Frankie: You'll have to pay 50 cents to find out.

Bunny Bigalow: It's probaly a silly dance. Or a you are going to paint silly pictures on our feet.

Viloetta: Whatever it is, a toe booth can't possibly make as much money as our booth.

Emily: I bet you a dollar that our booth wins. When we're rich and famous movie stars, a dollar won't mean anything.

Bunny: It's a bet.

Violetta: Taking candy from a baby.

Emily shook hands with her two worst enemies. The idea of those two winning one more thing made emily shudder. They were terrible winners. Bunny won the fifth grade spelling bee. Everytime someone would ask a question, she would spell the answer. Violetta put up a campaign in kindergarten to be elected captain of the toilet recess. Even when Emily was about to wet her pants, Violetta just smiled.

Violetta: Wait your turn. I'm the captain.

No matter what, Emily vowed, we're going to win that Grand Prize.

The day before the fair, Frankie called a special meeting of the Canal Street Club.

Frankie: I've made a list of jobs for the fair. It is only right for Emily to be the toe holder.

Spike, Emily and Tulu nod.

Frankie: Nobody is allowed to know what the toe show is until they see the toe.

Emily: We have to make them promise they won't tell anyone about the show.

Tulu: What if grown-ups want to come into our booth?

Emily: It's a kids-only fair. Only kids in our booth.

Frankie: Spike, you read the oath the kids have to make before they enter the booth.

Spike nods.

Emily: No oath. No toe.

Tulu: I'll be the curtain puller.

Frankie: ...

Emily: ...

Spike: ....

Frankie: Curtain puller it is. I'm going to be the announcer. Good practice for my career. Meet here at eight o'clock tomorrow morning and we'll get ready for The World's Greatest Toe Show.

All: Canal Street Forever! Forever and Ever!

When the Canal Street Kids got to school, the bake sale booth was already set up. Bunny Bigalow and Violetta Epstien wore matching blue aprons with red and blue bows in their hair. The Canal Street Club wasted no time getting everything ready. Hooking sheets onto nails all the way around the frame of the toe show booth. The customers could step inside and each peek of toe would be private.

Bunny: Dinosaurs, Mickey Mouse, and astronauts?

Emily: Our booth is colorful. What's wrong with mix and match.

Bunny: Your mix doesn't match. Our booth is color coordinated with various shades of periwinkle and cranberry.

Tulu: Looks like red and blue.

Spike: Matching colors don't forecast a winning booth.

Bunny: We'll see.

Frankie: "Step right up, ladies and gentleman! Come and see The World's Greatest Toe Show. It'll fascinate you! It'll shock you! It'll thrill you! Don't pass up this once-in-a-lifetime opportunity. Never before! Never Again! This is the gen-u-ine article! Step right up, ladies and gentlemen."

Spike: Are you prepared to take the oath?

Noah Benchley: What?

Spike: The oath of secrecy.

Noah: I guess.

Spike: Raise your right hand and repeat after me. "Cross my eyes and kiss my elbow, I promise not to reveal what I see in the toe booth today."

Noah: Cross my eyes.

Spike: Do you want to touch it? Seventy-five cents.

Noah enters the booth. From inside the booth we hear.

Noah: Wow! Are you serious! You rescued your Father's toe?!

Emily: It's the real thing.

Noah: Unbelievable!
By two-thirty, there was such a long line to see the toe show, Bunny Bigalow couldn't stand it any longer.

Bunny: I'm going over and find out what that toe booth is all about.

Violetta: I'll die if Emily Anderson wins instead of me. Positively, absolutely die!

Bunny: I've asked twenty kids and no one will tell me what the toe show is.

A shriek and a howl comes from the toe show booth.

Bunny: It must be interesting.

Violetta: Suit yourself.

TRANSITION

Spike: Do you want to peek or touch?

Bunny: Touch

Tulu: Next!

Emily: Ready to view the toe?

Bunny: What's the big deal?

Emily: This is my father's big toe. It got cut off in a bike accident.

Bunny: You're lying. A real cut off toe?

Emily: Girl Scout's honor. Ta-Da!

Bunny: It *is* a toe! It is!

Bunny's stomach begins to heave and she knocks the toe box to the ground.

Emily: You spilled my father's toe!

Bunny screams and rus.

Tulu: Help!

Bunny: Help!

CHAOS ENSUES

Spike: Wow.

Mr. Bottoms: Good Grief! The third graders are covered in purple and pink paint. Feathers cascading into the air. The balloon booth is tipped sideways. My dalmation, Spotty, was tied to the spin art booth and when he tried to run away, he took the booth with him. What in the world happened?!

Bunny: I can tell you exactly what happened. It's those Canal Street kids and Mr. Anderson's horrible shriveled-up toe.

Mr. Bottoms: What!?

Emily: My dad's toe. He lost it. Except it's not lost. I have it right here.

Mr. Bottoms: The Greatest Toe Show. A severed toe! I thought it was a dance!

Frankie: The toe show made lots of money for our school.

Spike: It's not our fault the booth tipped over.

Emily: It was the most exciting Spring Fair we've ever had.

Violetta: What about this disgusting mess? They've ruined everything! EVERYTHING!

Mr. Bottoms: If Mr. Anderson doesn't object to the toe display, I don't see why anyone else should, either. If we all get to work, this place will be cleaned up real fast. I'll count the money from the booths. We'll announce the winner of the Grand Prize soon.

TRANSITION

Mr. Bottoms: May I have your attention please? This Spring Fair raised more money than any other in the history of our school. And for the first time, we have two winners. The winners are . . . the bake sale and the toe show. Congratulations children!

Violetta: You owe us each a dollar.

Bunny: You didn't win.

Emily: Neither did you. It was a tie. You're not getting one penny.

Spike: We did it!

Frankie: We're going to have to be in a movie with Bunny Bigalow and Violetta Epstien.

Spike: . . .

TRANSITION

The day after the Spring Fair, The Canal Street Club gathered for a special meeting at Emily's house.

Emily: I don't think I should keep the toe anymore. I don't know what to do with it.

Tulu: Maybe the museum would like it.

Frankie: It's not old enough. What about a burial at sea?

Spike: Some fish would come along and eat it, get sick and vomit in the ocean.

Emily: Cremation!

Frankie: A Eulogy: "Farewell, farewell, O noble Toe. Thanks for starring in our show. We wish you may, we wish you might. Find a foot that fits just right."

The next evening, Emily tiptoed into her room and hid a large bag of ashes under her bed. Wait till next year. Just wait.